Informatica® Cloud Application Integration
August 2025

Box Connector Guide

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Preface

Read the *Box Connector Guide* to learn how to set up and use Box connections. Use the Box connection to automate interaction with the Box API. This guide assumes that you have an understanding of the Box concepts.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Box Connector

The Box Connector is a powerful integration tool designed to facilitate seamless interaction between your applications and the Box cloud content management platform. It enables users to connect, access, and manage files and folders stored in Box directly from within their workflows or applications, streamlining content collaboration and data management.

You can use the Box Connector in Application Integration to securely connect to Box and to upload, download, or delete files and folders.

Box Connector provides the following key features:

- Secure authentication with OAuth for safe access
- Upload, download, and manage files and folders in Box
- Search and retrieve content based on metadata and file attributes
- Create, update, and delete files and folders within workflows
- Share files and folders with internal and external users
- Automate content-related workflows and integrate with other applications
- Handle version control and track file changes
- Access and manage Box comments and collaborations

Box overview

Box is a cloud-based content management and file sharing platform designed to help businesses securely store, manage, and collaborate on their digital content. It provides a centralized repository where users can access documents and other files from any device with internet connectivity. The users in the enterprise can set access permissions to content in Box and collaborate seamlessly.

Box offers robust security features, including encryption, access controls, and compliance certifications, making it suitable for organizations with strict data governance requirements.

Box covers the following use cases:

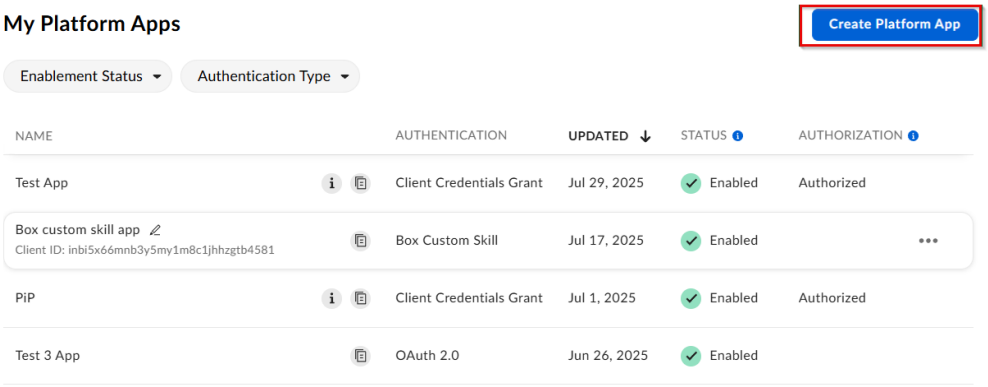
- Secure file storage and sharing across teams and organizations
- Collaborative document editing and version control
- Automated workflow integration with business applications
- Content governance and compliance management
- Mobile access to files and content from anywhere
- External sharing with partners and clients while maintaining security

- Digital asset management for marketing and creative teams

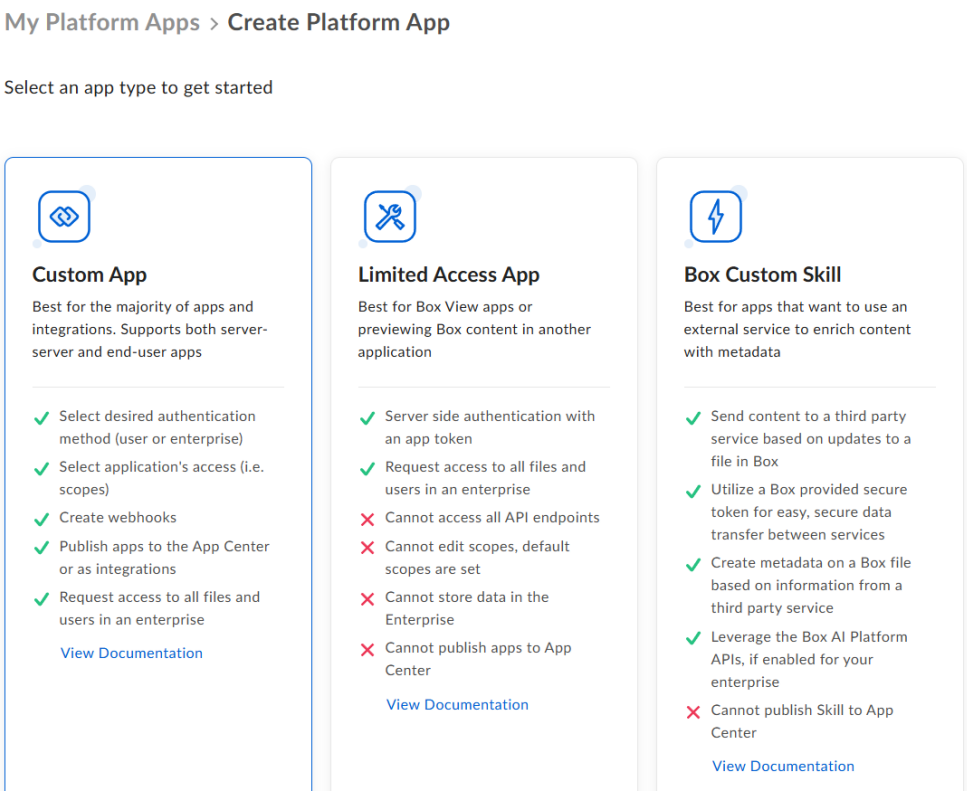
Creating a Box Platform Custom App

Before you use a Box connection, you must create a Box Platform Custom App to enable secure communication between applications and Box through API using Client Credentials Grant authentication. This involves setting up the app in the Box Developer Console, configuring authentication and permissions, and authorizing the app to access enterprise Box resources.

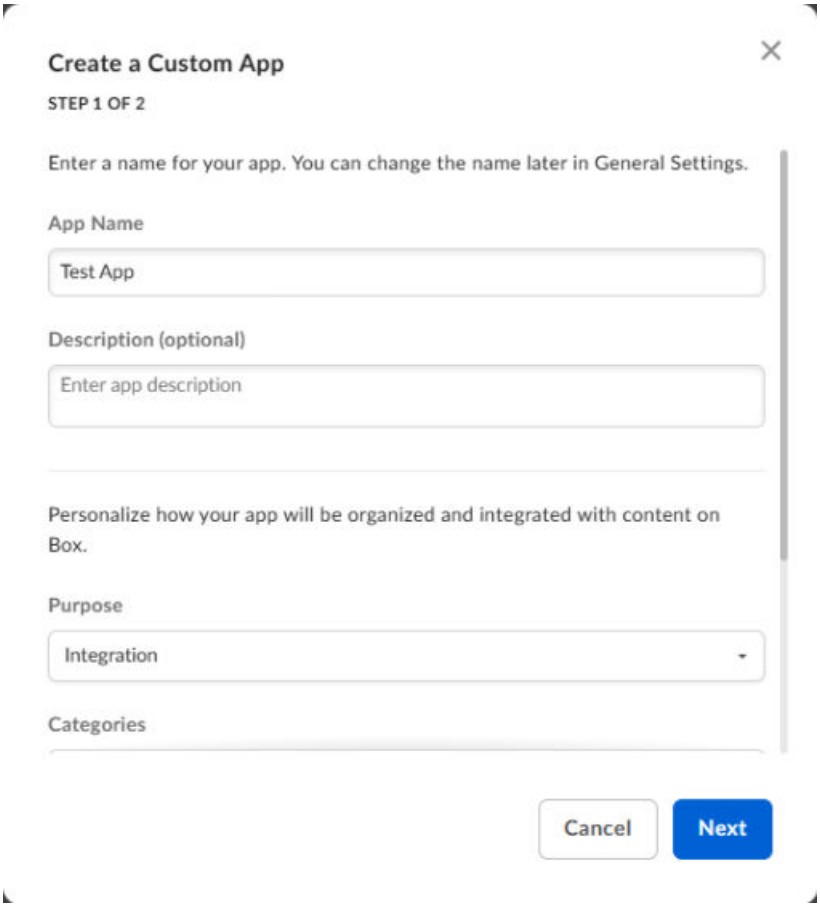
1. Log in to Box and go to the Developer Console.
2. On the **My Platform Apps** page, click **Create Platform App** as shown in the following image:



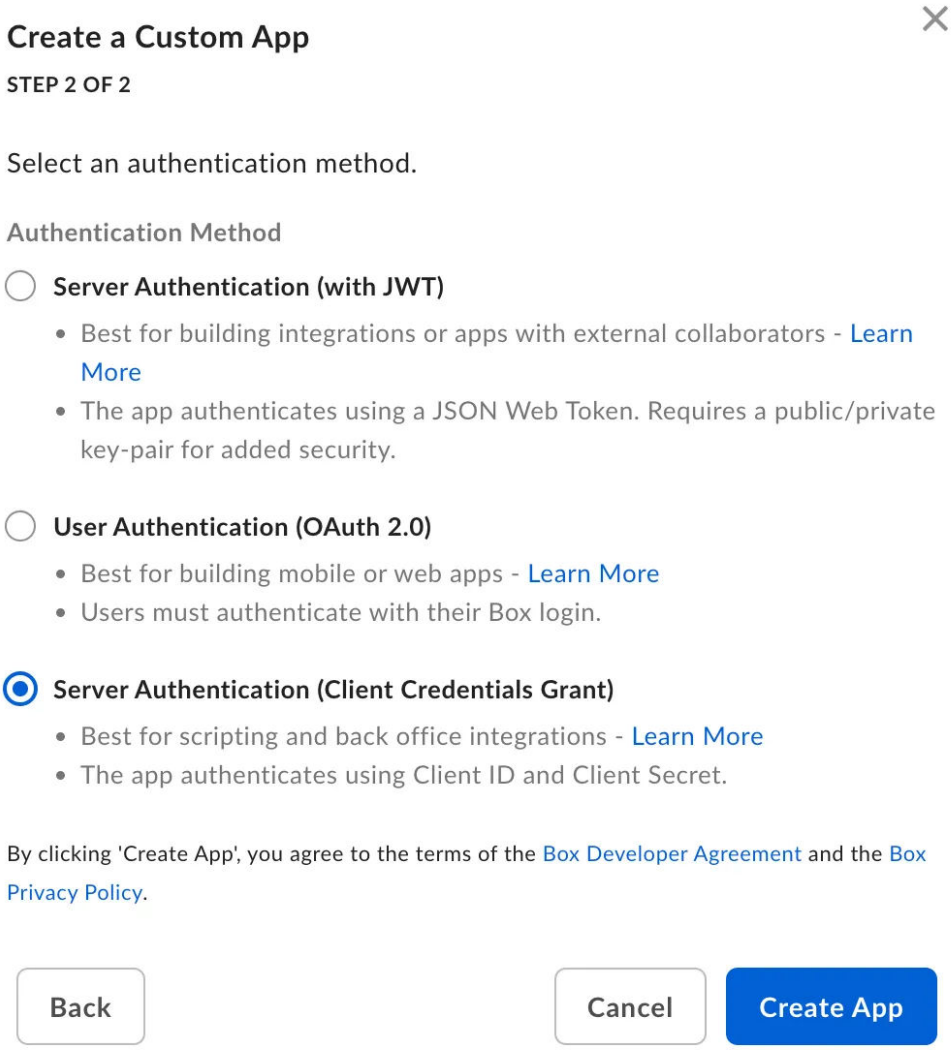
3. Select **Custom App** from the list of application types as shown in the following image:



4. Enter the app name, description, and select Integration from the **Purpose** list as shown in the following image:

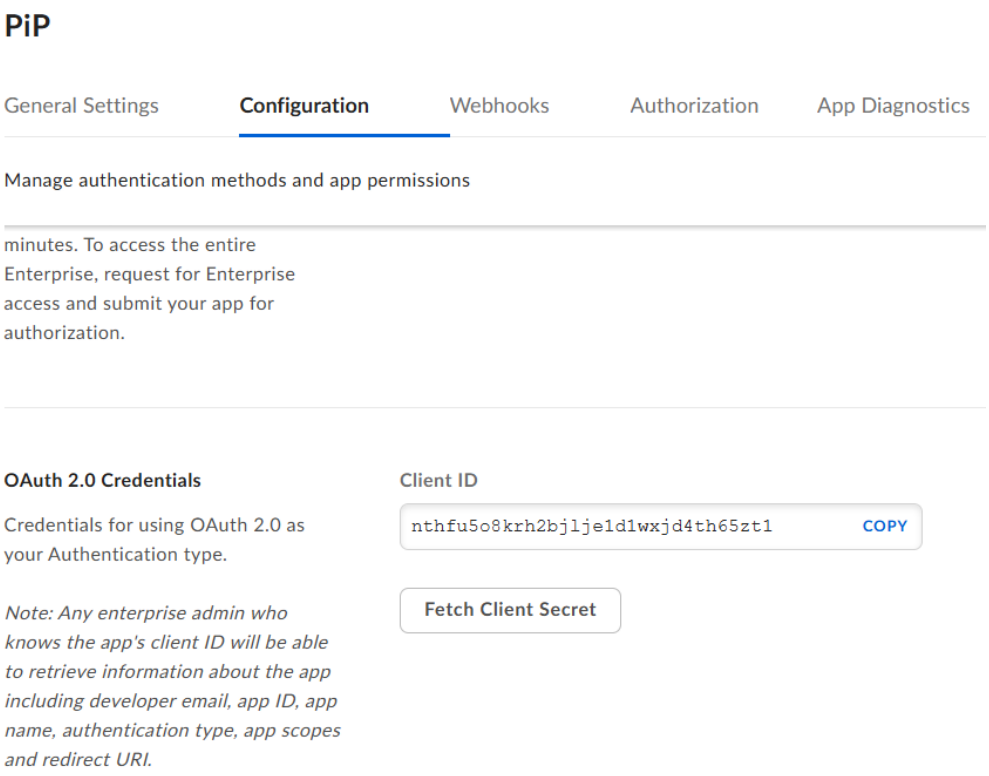


5. Select **Server Authentication (with Client Credentials Grant)** to verify application identity with a client ID and client secret as shown in the following image, and click **Create App**.



The Box Custom App is created and appears in the App list.

6. Open the app and go to the **Configuration** tab.
7. Copy the client ID and client secret as shown in the following image:



You will need the client ID and client secret while configuring the Box connection.

8. In the **Configuration** tab, set up the application scopes that the app requires to access Box resources.
9. Go to **Box Admin Console** > **Integrations** > **Platform App Manager** and click Add Platform App.
10. Enter the client ID and click **Create**.
    The app is authorized with access to your enterprise's Box content and users.

CHAPTER 2

Box connections

The Box Connector enables automated interaction with the Box API. You can perform CRUD operations, such as create, read, update, and delete on existing Box resources, such as files, folders, and comments.

You can perform actions, such as get access token, upload or download file, upload file version, get file or folder information, list items in folder, search for content, query object by metadata, create, delete, get, or update object.

After you create a Box connection, you can validate and save the connection.

You can then publish the Box connection and click the **Metadata** tab to view the generated process objects for the connection.

Basic connection properties

The following table describes the basic properties that you can configure on the **Properties** tab of the connection creation page:

Property	Description
Name	Required. Unique name for the Box connection that identifies it in the Process Designer. The name must start with an alphabet and can contain only alphabets, numbers, and hyphens (-).
Location	The location of the project or folder where you want to save the connection. Click **Browse** to select a location. If the **Explore** page is currently active and a project or folder is selected, the default location for the connection is the selected project or folder. Otherwise, the default location is the location of the most recently saved asset.
Description	Optional. Description of the connection.
Type	Required. The type of connection you want to use for the connector or service connector. Select **Box**.
Runtime Environment	Required. The runtime environment for the connection. You can run the connection on the Cloud Server, a Secure Agent group, or a Secure Agent machine.
Connection Test	Not supported for Box Connector.
OData-Enabled	Not supported for Box Connector.

After you configure the basic properties, you can define the OAuth2 authentication properties for the Box connection.

Box connection authentication properties

When you create a Box connection, you can configure the connection using OAuth2 authentication properties.

To authenticate the Box connection using OAuth2 authentication, expand the **OAuth2** section and configure the following properties:

Property	Description
Grant Type	Required. Select the required grant type based on your use case.
Authorization URL	Required. Enter the OAuth authorization URL for the OAuth provider to authorize the user request.
Token Request URL	Required. Enter the OAuth token request URL that handles token requests. The expiration of the refresh token depends on the OAuth provider. You must re-authenticate and publish the connection before the token expires. **Note:** The refresh token doesn't apply to agents and agent groups.
Client ID	Required. Specify the identifier value from the OAuth provider.
Client Secret	Required. Enter the client secret to connect to the email application.
Scope	Required. Specify the scope. The scope in OAuth authentication limits an application's access to a user's account. You can select multiple scopes for a single client. To enter multiple scopes, separate each value with a space.
Session duration	Optional. Enter the number of minutes to wait before refreshing the session. This is used if you cannot obtain the token expiration from the OAuth provider. Default is 60 minutes.
Other Parameters	Optional. Enter parameters to customize the authorization request, separated with semicolons. You can provide extra information or specify requirements of the OAuth provider.
Authorization Status	Indicates the current status, the name of the user who authorized, and the last time when the authorization was completed.
Authorize Access	Click to initiate the authorization workflow using OAuth.

For more information about OAuth 2.0, refer to the OAuth documentation.

Box connection properties

The following table defines the Box connection properties that you must configure in the **Connection Properties** section:

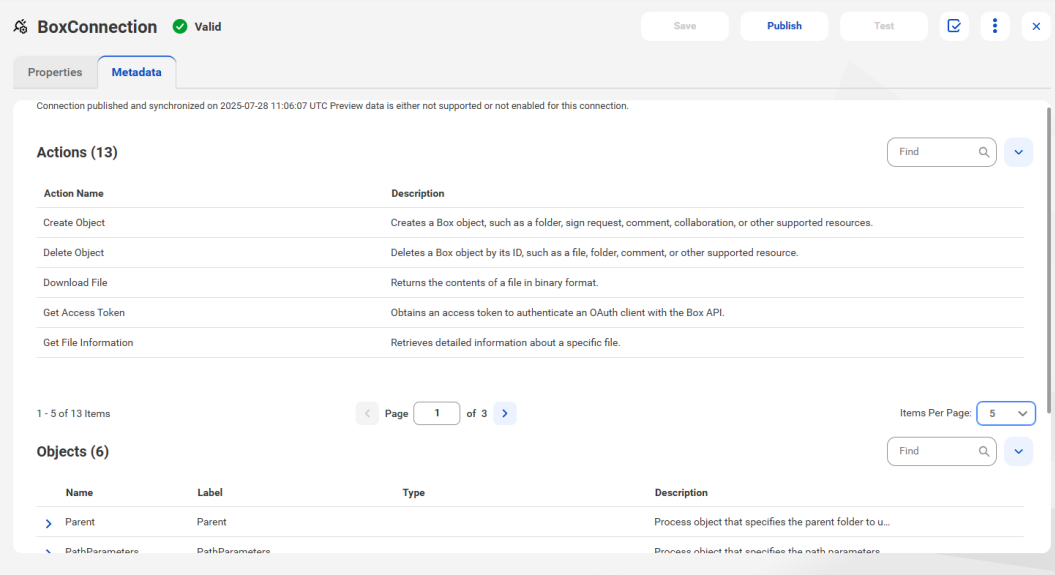
Property	Description
Client_ID	The client ID of the application requesting an access token.
Client_Secret	The client secret of the application requesting an access token.
Box_Subject_Type	The type of Box entity. Enter the value as **enterprise** or **user**.
Box_Subject_ID	The unique identifier of the Box subject.
API_Version	The URL path parameter that specifies the version of the Box API to use. For example, in the URL `https://api.box.com/2.0/files/12345`, the API version is `2.0`. If not specified, `2.0` is used by default.
Box_Version	The box-version header that specifies the API release version to use for the request. For example, `2024.0`.
Host	The hostname of the Box API endpoint to which the request is sent. For example, `api.box.com`.

Box connection metadata

After you create a Box connection, you can validate and save the connection. You can then publish the Box connection and click the **Metadata** tab to view the generated process objects for the connection.

When you publish a Box connection in Application Integration, the **Actions** and **Objects** appear on the **Metadata** tab.

The following image shows the **Metadata** tab for a published Box connection:



Box connection actions and objects

When you publish an Box connection in Application Integration, the **Actions** and **Objects** appear on the **Metadata** tab.

You must escape special characters in payloads as shown in the following table:

Symbol	Character	Replacement
<	left angle bracket or less than	<
>	right anlge bracket or greater than	>
{	left curly bracket or opening brace	{{
}	right curly bracket or closing brace	}}
&	ampersand	&

To use fields with data types, such as array, boolean, double, or integer, you must use annotation as shown in the following sample code:

```
<root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
<field_array m:isArray="true">
<property_1> ...</property_1>
</field_array>
<field_boolean m:type="xs:boolean">true</field_boolean>
<field_double m:type="xs:double">10.3</field_double>
<field_integer m:type="xs:int">5</field_integer>
</root>
```

The following fields are common for the Box connector actions:

- accessToken: Access token for the authorization header. This property can be obtained from the Get Access Token action.
- pathParameters: This field represents the path parameters in the API endpoint. For example, to copy a file, use the following endpoint:
  `https://api.box.com/2.0/files/{fileId}/copy`

  Here, `files/{fileId}/copy` are the path parameters.

  In this case, you must specify the path parameters, except for the API version 2.0, as it is either set by default or defined in the connection properties.

  You must maintain the correct order of the parameters.

  pathParameters example:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>files</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>1234567890</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>copy</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```
- queryParameters: This field represents the query parameters for the request. These parameters are appended to the API endpoint URL and are used to filter, sort, or specify additional details about the query.
  queryParameters example:

  ```
  <root>
  <parameterName>parameterValue</parameterName>
  <parameterName>parameterValue</parameterName>
  <parameterName>parameterValue</parameterName>
  </root>
  ```

Consider the following information when you use specific actions and objects:

- The **Get Access Token** action creates a bearer token that allows an OAuth client to authenticate with the Box API using parameter values from the connection properties.
- The **Upload File** action uploads a new file to Box.
  Attach a file and provide the file name, along with the parent folder to upload the file to, in the request body.

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <name>test.txt</name>
  <parent>
  <id>327497224477</id>
  </parent>
  </root>
  ```

  Response returns the new file object in a list.
- The **Upload File Version** action uploads a new version of an existing file to Box.
  Provide the file ID for which you want to upload a new version and attach the file version. You can also include optional values in the request body.

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <name>test_v2.txt</name>
  </root>
  ```

  Response returns the new file object in a list.
- The **Get File Information** action retrieves detailed information about a specific file using ID.
  Example of retrieving file information using a password-protected shared link:

  - Provide the file ID in the fileId field.

- Enter the shared link and password in the boxapi field in the following format:
  `shared_link=https://app.box.com/s/abcdef123456789&shared_link_password=Pass!1234`

- The **Get Folder Information** action retrieves details about a folder using ID, including up to the first 100 items contained within it.
  Example of retrieving folder information using a password-protected shared link:
  - Provide the folder ID in the folderId field.
  - Enter the shared link and password in the boxapi field in the following format:
    `shared_link=https://app.box.com/s/abcdef123456789&shared_link_password=Pass!1234`
- The **List Items In Folder** action retrieves a paginated list of items contained in a folder using the ID.
  The following snippet is an example of retrieving a list of two item names and their IDs in a folder, using sorting, filtering, and pagination through query parameters:

  You must provide the folder ID in the folderId field.

  Query parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <fields>name, id</fields>
  <sort>name</sort>
  <limit>2</limit>
  <usemarker>true</usemarker>
  </root>
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample response:

  ```
  <root>

  <next_marker>eyJ0eXBlIjoiZmlsZSIsImRpciI6Im5leHQiLCJ0YWlsIjoiZXlKMWMyVnlYMmxrSWpvME1qa
  zRPVEF6T1RjMU9Td2labTlzWkdWeVgybGtJam96TWpjME9UY3lNalEwTnpjc0ltUmxiR1YwWldRaU9qQXNJbVp
  wYkdWZmJtRnRaU0k2SW14dmNtVnRMbkJrWmlJc0ltWnBiR1ZmYVdRaU9qRTVNVEE0TkRZeE16STRPVGg5In0=<
  /next_marker>
    <entries>
     <name>Text files - Copy</name>
     <etag>0</etag>
     <id>328080769791</id>
     <type>folder</type>
    </entries>
    <entries>
     <name>lorem.pdf</name>
     <etag>0</etag>
     <id>1910846132898</id>
     <type>file</type>
    </entries>
    <limit>2</limit>
    <order>
     <by>name</by>
     <direction>ASC</direction>
    </order>
  </root>
  ```

- The **Search For Content** action searches for files, folders, web links, and shared files either within the user's content or across the entire enterprise.
  Provide search information about an object in the query parameters.

  The following snippet is an example of searching for a text file named Test:

  queryParameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <type>file</type>
  <content_types>name</content_types>
  <file_extensions>txt</file_extensions>
  <query>test</query>
  </root>
  ```

- The **Query Object By Metadata** action performs a search using SQL-like syntax to return items that match specific metadata criteria.
  By default, this action returns only the most basic information about the items for which the query matches. To get additional fields for each item, including any of the metadata, use the fields attribute in the query.

  Specify the metadata template used in the query. It must be in the following format in the request body:

  ```
  scope.templateKey. ancestor folder ID
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <from>enterprise_1234567890.customer</from>
  <query>name = :name_value</query>
  <query_params>
  <name_value>John</name_value>
  </query_params>
  <ancestor_folder_id>0987654321</ancestor_folder_id>
  </root>
  ```

- The **Create Object** action creates a Box object, such as a folder, sign request, comment, collaboration, or other supported resources.
  To use the Create Object action, specify the path parameters for the object you want to create or copy. Also, provide values for the requestBody and queryParameters fields, if required.

  Example of creating a folder:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>folders</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <name>Documents</name>
  <parent>
  <id>0</id>
  </parent>
  </root>
  ```

  If the provided values are correct, the response will return a Folder object.

  Example of copying a folder:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>folders</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>0123456789</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>copy</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <name>Documents_copy</name>
  <parent>
  <id>0</id>
  </parent>
  </root>
  ```

  If the provided values are correct, the response will return a Folder object.

  Example of creating a sign request:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>sign_requests</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

The following snippet is a sample request body:

```
<root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
<signers m:isArray="true">
<role>signer</role>
<email>example@example.com</email>
</signers>
<source_files m:isArray="true">
<type>file</type>
<id>0123456789</id>
</source_files>
<parent_folder>
<type>folder</type>
<id>9876543210</id>
</parent_folder>
</root>
```

- The **Delete Object** action deletes a Box object by its ID, such as a file, folder, comment, or other supported resource.
  To use the Delete Object action, provide the path parameters of the object you want to delete. Also, provide a value for the queryParameters field if required.

  The following snippet is an example of deleting a folder:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>folders</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>332066581615</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

- The **Get Object** action retrieves Box object information, such as a file request, comment, collaboration, or other supported resource.
  To use the Get Object action, provide the path parameters for the object you want to retrieve. Also, provide a value for the queryParameters field if required.

  The following snippet is an example of retrieving a list of items in a folder, additionally filtered and sorted using query parameters:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>folders</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>329237142032</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>items</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

  Query parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <fields>name, id</fields>
  <sort>name</sort>
  </root>
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample response:

  ```
  <root>
    <entries>
     <name>js.png</name>
     <etag>0</etag>
     <id>1913482002032</id>
     <type>file</type>
    </entries>
    <entries>
     <name>js2.png</name>
     <etag>0</etag>
     <id>1916868805650</id>
     <type>file</type>
    </entries>
    <entries>
     <name>lorem2_copy.txt</name>
  ```

```
    <etag>0</etag>
    <id>1916853796452</id>
    <type>file</type>
   </entries>
   <offset>0</offset>
   <total_count>3</total_count>
   <limit>100</limit>
   <order>
    <by>type</by>
    <direction>ASC</direction>
   </order>
   <order>
    <by>name</by>
    <direction>ASC</direction>
   </order>
</root>
```

- The **Update Object** action updates an existing Box object, such as a file request, folder, file, or other supported resource.
  To use the Update Object action, provide the path parameters for the object you want to update. Also, include values for the requestBody and queryParameters fields if required.

  Example of updating a folder:

  Path parameters:

  ```
  <root>
  <pathParameter>folders</pathParameter>
  <pathParameter>332066581615</pathParameter>
  </root>
  ```

  The following snippet is a sample request body:

  ```
  <root>
  <name>New folder name</name>
  </root>
  ```

  If the provided values are correct, the response will return the updated folder object.

- The **Download File** action returns the contents of a file in binary format.
  Provide the file ID of the file you want to download in the fileId field.

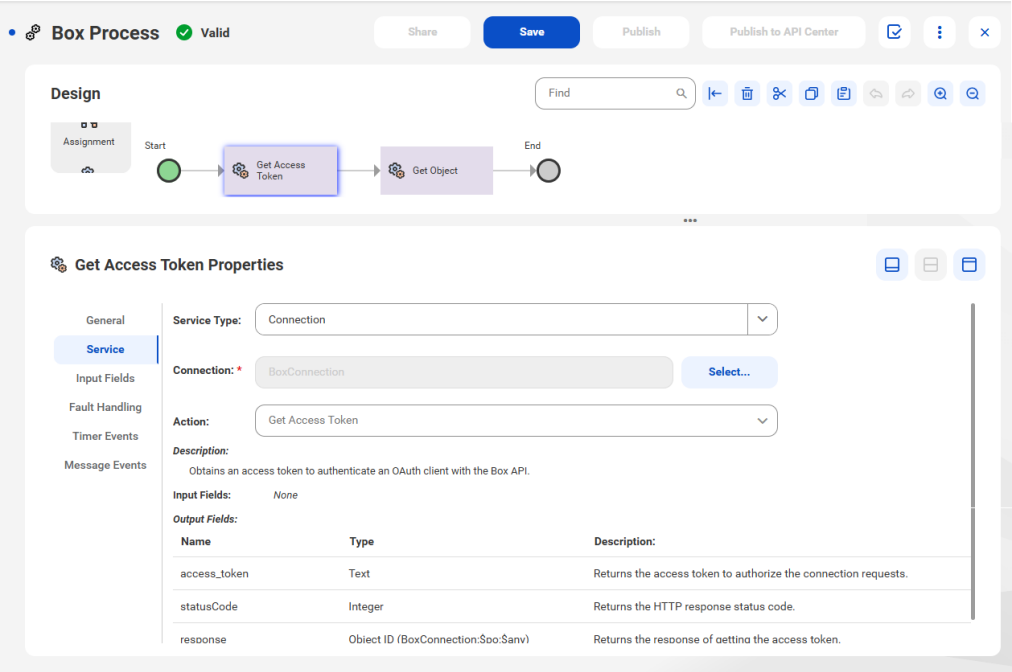
  Response returns the requested file.

For more information, see the Box API reference documentation.

Using a Box connection in a process

After you create a Box connection, you can use it in a Service step in a process.

1. Add a Service step to the process.
2. Click the **Service** tab.
3. From the **Service Type** list, select **Connection**.
4. From the **Connection** list, browse and select the Box connection that you created.
5. From the **Action** list, select the action that you want to perform. For example, select the **Get Access Token** action to obtain an access token to authenticate an OAuth client with the Box API as shown in the following image:



In this case, Application Integration populates the **access_token**, **statusCode**, and **response** objects under the output fields.

6. Configure further steps as needed.
7. Validate, save, and publish the process.